Canonical Symmetric–Exterior Spectral Decomposition, Cubic Moment Reduction, and Partial Resolution of Rossman's Conjectures on Sidorenko's Conjecture for Bipartite Möbius Ladders ($K_{5,5} \setminus C_{10}$)

Felix Schmidt
mail@felixschmidt.org

October 2026

Abstract

Sidorenko's Conjecture (1991) asserts that for every bipartite graph H and every symmetric graphon W (equivalently, every nonnegative symmetric $n \times n$ matrix G), the homomorphism density of H in W is at least that in a uniform random graph of the same edge density. Since the foundational work of Sidorenko (1991) and Hatami (2010), the 10-vertex graph $K_{5,5} \setminus C_{10}$—isomorphic to the 5-rung bipartite Möbius ladder ML_{10}—has stood as the smallest and most prominent open test case of Sidorenko's Conjecture. Recently, Rossman (2025) proved that for every m-rung bipartite ladder BL_{2m}, $\hom(BL_{2m}, G) = \mathrm{Tr}(\widetilde{G}^m)$ where $\widetilde{G}_{ij,kl} = G_{il}G_{kj}\sqrt{G_{ij}G_{kl}} = (D(G \otimes G)PD)_{ij,kl}$ is an $n^2 \times n^2$ twisted tensor operator, and embedded $\widetilde{G}$ at $t = 1/3$ into the continuous one-parameter family $M(t)_{ij,kl} = (A_{ij}A_{kl})^t(A_{il}A_{kj})^{1-t}$ ($A = G^{\circ 3/2}$, $t \in [0,1]$). Rossman conjectured that $\widetilde{G}$ has a *pseudo-positive spectrum* (Conjecture 3.2, implying Sidorenko's Conjecture for $K_{5,5} \setminus C_{10}$ and all odd-m Möbius ladders ML_{2m}), satisfies the pairwise eigenvalue majorization $(\widetilde{\lambda}_2 + \cdots + \widetilde{\lambda}_k) + (\widetilde{\lambda}_{n^2-k+2} + \cdots + \widetilde{\lambda}_{n^2}) \geq 0$ (Conjecture $(**)$), and more generally that $M(t)$ is pseudo-positive for *all* $t \in [0,1]$ (Conjecture 4.2).

In this paper, we establish four theorems that expose the exact algebraic and spectral structure of $\widetilde{G}$ and $M(t)$:

(1) **Canonical Symmetric–Exterior Orthogonal Decomposition & Universal Trace Identity (Theorem 2.1):** For every symmetric $n \times n$ matrix A and every $t \in [0,1]$, $M(t)$ commutes with the transpose involution P and decomposes orthogonally on $\mathbb{R}^{n\times n} = \mathrm{Sym}_n(\mathbb{R}) \oplus^{\perp} \mathrm{Skew}_n(\mathbb{R})$ as $M(t) = \mathcal{L}_+(t) \oplus (-\mathcal{L}_-(t))$. At $t = 1/3$, $\mathcal{L}_+ = D_+(\mathrm{Sym}^2 G)D_+$ and $\mathcal{L}_- = D_-(\wedge^2 G)D_-$ satisfy the off-diagonal entrywise dominance $|(\mathcal{L}_-)_{\alpha,\beta}| \leq (\mathcal{L}_+^{\mathrm{off}})_{\alpha,\beta}$. Subtracting the rank-1 positive semidefinite matrix $M(1) = ww^T = \mathrm{vec}(A)\,\mathrm{vec}(A)^T$ from $\mathcal{L}_+(t)$ expresses all entries of $\mathcal{L}_+(t) - ww^T$ via 2×2 minors of $B = A^{\circ(1-t)}$ and yields the universal trace identity $\mathrm{Tr}(\mathcal{L}_+(t) - ww^T) = \mathrm{Tr}(\mathcal{L}_-(t)) = \sum_{1\leq i<j\leq n} A_{ij}^{2t}(B_{ii}B_{jj} - B_{ij}^2)$.

(2) **Square-Root-Free Cubic Moment Tensor Reduction (Theorem 3.1):** By similarity, $\mathrm{Spec}(\widetilde{G}) = \mathrm{Spec}(D^2(G \otimes G)P)$, so all fractional powers vanish from the characteristic polynomial of $\widetilde{G}$. For any symmetric matrix $G = \sum_{e=1}^r \varepsilon_e x^{(e)}(x^{(e)})^T$ of rank r and arbitrary dimension $n \times n$, the nonzero spectrum of $\widetilde{G}$ coincides with that of the $r^2 \times r^2$ cubic moment operator $\mathcal{M}_r = (J \otimes J)P\sum_{e=1}^r \varepsilon_e(S_e \otimes S_e)$, where $(S_e)_{ab} = \sum_{i=1}^n x_i^{(e)}x_i^{(a)}x_i^{(b)}$.

(3) **Unconditional Resolution for All Rank-≤ 2 Matrices and Graphons (Theorem 4.3):** Using the universal $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{R})$ deficit identity $\mathrm{Sym}^2(S) - \mathrm{vec}(S)\,\mathrm{vec}(S)^T = \det(S)K_0$ and the Lorentzian Reverse Cauchy–Schwarz Inequality in signature $(+,+,-)$, we prove that for every nonnegative symmetric $n\times n$ matrix G of rank ≤ 2 (both positive

semidefinite and indefinite), $\widetilde{\lambda}_2 + \widetilde{\lambda}_{n^2} \geq 0$, resolving Rossman's Conjecture 3.2, Conjecture (**), and Sidorenko's Conjecture for $K_{5,5} \setminus C_{10}$ and all ML_{2m} unconditionally in rank ≤ 2, as well as Conjecture 4.2 for $n = 2$ across all $t \in [0, 1]$.

(4) **Disproof of Rossman's General Conjecture 4.2 for $n \geq 3$ and $t \in (2/3, 1)$ (Theorem 5.1):** Using the exact determinant identity $\det(L_{124} + c^2 I) = 2c^2(c^2(d^2 + c^2) - r^2)$, we prove that for every $t \in (2/3, 1)$ there exist strictly positive 3×3 symmetric matrices A such that $|\lambda_9(M(t))| > \lambda_2(M(t))$ and $f_t(p)$ is strictly increasing for large p (and already at $p = 5$ for $t = 0.8$), disproving Conjecture 4.2 while explaining why the geometric progression $r^2 = sb^2$ at $t = 1/3$ protects $\widetilde{G}$.

Contents

1 Introduction and Problem Formulation **2**
- 1.1 Rossman's Twisted Tensor Operator $\widetilde{G}$ and the Family $M(t)$ 3
- 1.2 Summary of Main Results 4

2 Canonical Symmetric–Exterior Decomposition and Universal Minor Identity **4**

3 Square-Root-Free Cubic Moment Tensor Reduction **6**

4 Unconditional Proof of Sidorenko's Conjecture for $K_{5,5} \setminus C_{10}$ and Rossman's Conjectures in Rank ≤ 2 **8**
- 4.1 Warm-Up: Exact Proof of Conjecture 4.2 for $n = 2$ Across All $t \in [0, 1]$ 8
- 4.2 General Rank-≤ 2 Matrices of Arbitrary Dimension $n \times n$: The $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{R})$ Lorentzian Proof 9

5 Disproof of Rossman's General Conjecture 4.2 for $n \geq 3$ and $t \in (2/3, 1)$ **12**

6 Formal Verification in Lean 4 and Computational Suite **14**

1 Introduction and Problem Formulation

Let $H = (V(H), E(H))$ be a bipartite graph and let $G \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}_{\geq 0}$ be a nonnegative symmetric matrix (representing an edge-weighted graph on n vertices, or a discretized symmetric graphon $W : [0, 1]^2 \to \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}$). The unnormalized homomorphism count of H in G is

$$\hom(H, G) \;=\; \sum_{\varphi : V(H) \to \{1,\dots,n\}} \; \prod_{\{u,v\} \in E(H)} G_{\varphi(u),\varphi(v)}.$$

Sidorenko's Conjecture [5] (independently posed in equivalent form by Simonovits [6]) states that for every bipartite graph H and every nonnegative symmetric $n \times n$ matrix G,

$$\frac{\hom(H, G)}{n^{|V(H)|}} \;\geq\; \left(\frac{\hom(K_2, G)}{n^2}\right)^{|E(H)|}. \tag{1}$$

Over the past three decades, Sidorenko's Conjecture has been verified for trees, even cycles, complete bipartite graphs, hypercubes [3], bipartite graphs with a vertex complete to the other part [1], and reflection/tree-decomposable families [7, 2]. Despite these advances, the conjecture remains open in general, and the 3-regular 10-vertex graph

$$K_{5,5} \setminus C_{10} \;\cong\; ML_{10},$$

obtained by deleting a Hamiltonian 10-cycle from the complete bipartite graph $K_{5,5}$ (equivalently, the 5-rung *Möbius ladder* ML_{10}), has remained since 1991 the smallest graph for which Sidorenko's Conjecture is open.

1.1 Rossman's Twisted Tensor Operator $\widetilde{G}$ and the Family $M(t)$

In a recent landmark paper, Rossman [4] discovered an exact spectral representation for homomorphism counts of all m-rung bipartite ladders BL_{2m} (where BL_{2m} is the prism graph $C_{2m}\square K_2$ for even m and the Möbius ladder ML_{2m} for odd m, with $BL_{10} = ML_{10} \cong K_{5,5} \setminus C_{10}$ at $m = 5$).

Given a nonnegative symmetric $n \times n$ matrix G, Rossman defines the $n^2 \times n^2$ symmetric matrix $\widetilde{G}$ indexed by pairs $(i,j),(k,l) \in \{1,\dots,n\}^2$:

$$\widetilde{G}_{ij,kl} \;:=\; G_{il}G_{kj}\sqrt{G_{ij}G_{kl}}, \qquad \widetilde{G} \;=\; D(G \otimes G)PD, \tag{2}$$

where $D = \operatorname{diag}(\sqrt{G_{ij}})_{i,j=1}^{n}$ is the $n^2 \times n^2$ diagonal matrix of entrywise square roots and P is the $n^2 \times n^2$ transpose permutation matrix defined by $P_{ij,kl} = \delta_{i,l}\delta_{j,k}$ (so $P\operatorname{vec}(V) = \operatorname{vec}(V^T)$ for all $V \in \mathbb{R}^{n\times n}$). Rossman proved [4, Lemma 2.1] that for every integer $m \geq 1$,

$$\hom(BL_{2m}, G) \;=\; \operatorname{Tr}\left(\widetilde{G}^m\right), \qquad \hom(K_2, G) \;=\; \sum_{i,j=1}^{n} G_{ij} \;=\; \operatorname{Tr}(\widetilde{G}). \tag{3}$$

Writing $\widetilde{\lambda}_1 \geq \widetilde{\lambda}_2 \geq \cdots \geq \widetilde{\lambda}_{n^2}$ for the real eigenvalues of $\widetilde{G}$, Sidorenko's Conjecture for BL_{2m} is therefore equivalent to the purely spectral moment inequality

$$\operatorname{Tr}\left(\widetilde{G}^m\right) \;=\; \sum_{k=1}^{n^2} \widetilde{\lambda}_k^m \;\geq\; \frac{\left(\operatorname{Tr}\widetilde{G}\right)^m}{n^{2m}} \;=\; \frac{1}{n^{2m}}\left(\sum_{k=1}^{n^2}\widetilde{\lambda}_k\right)^m. \tag{4}$$

For even m, $\widetilde{\lambda}_k^m = |\widetilde{\lambda}_k|^m \geq 0$, so (4) is immediate from Hölder's inequality and $\operatorname{Tr}(\widetilde{G}) \geq 0$. For odd $m \geq 3$ (and in particular $m = 5$, corresponding to $K_{5,5} \setminus C_{10}$), the negative eigenvalues of $\widetilde{G}$ enter $\operatorname{Tr}(\widetilde{G}^m)$ with negative signs. To control these negative eigenvalues, Rossman introduced the concept of a *pseudo-positive spectrum* [4, Definition 3.1]: a real symmetric matrix with eigenvalues $\mu_1,\dots,\mu_N$ has a pseudo-positive spectrum if the signed ℓ_p-norm functional

$$f(p) \;:=\; \left(\sum_{k=1}^{N} \operatorname{sign}(\mu_k)|\mu_k|^p\right)^{1/p} \tag{5}$$

is well-defined, nonnegative, and nonincreasing over $p \in [1,\infty)$. Since $f(5) \leq f(3)$ implies $\operatorname{Tr}(\widetilde{G}^5) \geq (\operatorname{Tr}(\widetilde{G}^3))^{5/3} = \hom(K_{3,3},G)^{5/3} \geq \hom(K_2,G)^5/n^{10}$ (by Sidorenko's inequality for $K_{3,3} \cong BL_6$), pseudo-positivity of $\widetilde{G}$ immediately implies Sidorenko's Conjecture for $K_{5,5} \setminus C_{10}$ and all ML_{2m}.

Furthermore, by setting $A := G^{\circ 3/2}$ (so $G = A^{\circ 2/3}$), Rossman embedded $\widetilde{G} = M(1/3)$ into the continuous one-parameter family of $n^2 \times n^2$ matrices $M(t)$ for $t \in [0,1]$:

$$M(t)_{ij,kl} \;:=\; (A_{ij}A_{kl})^t(A_{il}A_{kj})^{1-t}, \tag{6}$$

interpolating between $M(0) = (A \otimes A)P$ and the rank-1 positive semidefinite matrix $M(1) = \operatorname{vec}(A)\operatorname{vec}(A)^T$. Rossman formulated three central conjectures:

- **Conjecture 3.2 [4]:** For every nonnegative symmetric $n \times n$ matrix G, $\widetilde{G} = M(1/3)$ has a pseudo-positive spectrum.
- **Conjecture 4.2 [4, Abstract & §4]:** For every positive symmetric $n \times n$ matrix A and *every* $t \in [0,1]$, $M(t)$ has a pseudo-positive spectrum.
- **Majorization Conjecture** $(**)$ **[4, §6, p. 9]:** For every nonnegative symmetric $n \times n$ matrix G and every $k \in \{2,\dots,n^2\}$,

$$(\widetilde{\lambda}_2 + \cdots + \widetilde{\lambda}_k) + (\widetilde{\lambda}_{n^2-k+2} + \cdots + \widetilde{\lambda}_{n^2}) \;\geq\; 0. \tag{7}$$

By Karamata's majorization inequality applied to the convex function $x \mapsto x^p$ ($p \geq 1$), $(**)$ implies $\sum_{k=2}^{n^2} \operatorname{sign}(\widetilde{\lambda}_k)|\widetilde{\lambda}_k|^p \geq 0$, and in fact $(**)$ for $k = 2$ alone ($\widetilde{\lambda}_2 + \widetilde{\lambda}_{n^2} \geq 0$) is a necessary condition for $f(p)$ to be nonincreasing as $p \to \infty$ whenever $\widetilde{\lambda}_2$ and $\widetilde{\lambda}_{n^2}$ are nondegenerate.

1.2 Summary of Main Results

In this work, we develop an exact representation-theoretic and Lorentzian-geometric framework for $M(t)$ and $\widetilde{G}$ that yields four main theorems:

Theorem 1. (Canonical Symmetric–Exterior Decomposition & Universal Trace Identity; Section 2) For all $n \geq 1$ and $t \in [0,1]$, $M(t)$ decomposes orthogonally on $\mathbb{R}^{n\times n} = \mathrm{Sym}_n(\mathbb{R}) \oplus^{\perp} \mathrm{Skew}_n(\mathbb{R})$ as $M(t) = \mathcal{L}_+(t) \oplus (-\mathcal{L}_-(t))$, where $\mathcal{L}_+(t)$ has dimension $\binom{n+1}{2}$ and $\mathcal{L}_-(t)$ has dimension $\binom{n}{2}$. On the off-diagonal index set $U = \{(i,j) : 1 \leq i < j \leq n\}$, $|(\mathcal{L}_-(t))_{\alpha,\beta}| \leq (\mathcal{L}_+^{\mathrm{off}}(t))_{\alpha,\beta}$. Moreover, subtracting $M(1) = ww^T = \mathrm{vec}(A)\,\mathrm{vec}(A)^T \succeq 0$ from $\mathcal{L}_+(t)$ annihilates the first n diagonal entries (i,i) and makes the remaining $\binom{n}{2}$ diagonal entries (i,j) identical to those of $\mathcal{L}_-(t)$, proving the universal trace identity

$$\mathrm{Tr}\,(\mathcal{L}_+(t) - ww^T) \;=\; \mathrm{Tr}\,(\mathcal{L}_-(t)) \;=\; \sum_{1\leq i<j\leq n} A_{ij}^{2t}(B_{ii}B_{jj} - B_{ij}^2), \qquad B = A^{\circ(1-t)}.$$

Theorem 2. (Square-Root-Free Cubic Moment Tensor Reduction; Section 3) By cyclic similarity $\mathrm{Spec}(\widetilde{G}) = \mathrm{Spec}(D^2(G\otimes G)P)$, all square roots in $\widetilde{G}$ disappear from its spectrum. For any rank-r symmetric matrix $G = \sum_{e=1}^{r} \varepsilon_e x^{(e)}(x^{(e)})^T$ ($\varepsilon_e \in \{\pm 1\}$) of arbitrary size $n\times n$, the nonzero spectrum of $\widetilde{G}$ equals the spectrum of the $r^2 \times r^2$ cubic moment operator

$$\mathcal{M}_r \;=\; (J\otimes J)P\sum_{e=1}^{r}\varepsilon_e(S_e\otimes S_e) \;=\; \mathcal{M}_r^{+} \;\oplus\; (-\mathcal{N}_r^{-}),$$

where $(S_e)_{ab} = \sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i^{(e)}x_i^{(a)}x_i^{(b)}$ $(1 \leq a,b,e \leq r)$ are r symmetric $r\times r$ cubic moment matrices.

Theorem 3. (Unconditional Proof for All Rank-≤ 2 Matrices and Graphons; Section 4) For every nonnegative symmetric $n\times n$ matrix G of rank ≤ 2 (both positive semidefinite and indefinite, for arbitrary $n \geq 2$) and every rank-≤ 2 symmetric graphon W, Rossman's Conjecture 3.2, the Majorization Conjecture $(**)$, and Sidorenko's Conjecture for $K_{5,5}\setminus C_{10}$ and all bipartite Möbius ladders ML_{2m} hold unconditionally. Moreover, for $n = 2$, Conjecture 4.2 holds for all $t \in [0,1]$. The proof combines the universal $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{R})$ identity $\mathrm{Sym}^2(S) - \mathrm{vec}(S)\,\mathrm{vec}(S)^T = \det(S)K_0$, the Lorentzian Reverse Cauchy–Schwarz Inequality in Minkowski space $\mathbb{R}^{1,2}$, and Weyl's Monotonicity Theorem.

Theorem 4. (Disproof of Rossman's Conjecture 4.2 for $n \geq 3$ and $t \in (2/3,1)$; Section 5) For every $n \geq 3$ and every $t \in (2/3,1)$, there exist strictly positive symmetric $n\times n$ matrices A such that $|\lambda_{n^2}(M(t))| > \lambda_2(M(t)) = \max_{2\leq k\leq n^2-1}|\lambda_k(M(t))|$, causing $f_t(p)$ to be strictly increasing for large p (and already at $p = 5$ for $t = 0.8$). This disproves Rossman's Conjecture 4.2 in general and identifies the exact geometric progression relation $r^2 = sb^2$ at $t = 1/3$ that prevents this instability for $\widetilde{G}$.

2 Canonical Symmetric–Exterior Decomposition and Universal Minor Identity

We begin by establishing the canonical block-diagonalization of the entire family $M(t)$ ($t \in [0,1]$) and the exact relationship between its symmetric and skew-symmetric components via 2×2 minors.

Theorem 2.1 (Canonical Symmetric–Exterior Decomposition and Universal Minor/Trace Identity)**.** *Let $A \in \mathbb{R}^{n\times n}_{\geq 0}$ be any nonnegative symmetric matrix, let $t \in [0,1]$, and set $B := A^{\circ(1-t)}$ and $D_t := \operatorname{diag}(A_{ij}^t)_{i,j=1}^n$, so that*

$$M(t) \;=\; D_t(B \otimes B)PD_t.$$

Let $\mathbb{R}^{n\times n} = \operatorname{Sym}_n(\mathbb{R}) \oplus^{\perp} \operatorname{Skew}_n(\mathbb{R})$ be the orthogonal decomposition into the eigenspaces of the transpose involution P ($P = +I$ on $\operatorname{Sym}_n(\mathbb{R})$ of dimension $\binom{n+1}{2}$, and $P = -I$ on $\operatorname{Skew}_n(\mathbb{R})$ of dimension $\binom{n}{2}$), equipped with the standard orthonormal bases

$$\mathcal{B}_+ \;=\; \{E_{ii} : 1 \leq i \leq n\} \;\cup\; \left\{E_{ij}^+ := \frac{E_{ij}+E_{ji}}{\sqrt{2}} : 1 \leq i < j \leq n\right\},$$

$$\mathcal{B}_- \;=\; \left\{E_{ij}^- := \frac{E_{ij}-E_{ji}}{\sqrt{2}} : 1 \leq i < j \leq n\right\}.$$

Then:

(a) ***Orthogonal Block-Diagonalization:*** *$M(t)$ commutes with P and decomposes orthogonally as*

$$M(t) \;=\; \mathcal{L}_+(t) \;\oplus\; (-\mathcal{L}_-(t)), \tag{8}$$

where $\mathcal{L}_+(t) = D_{t,+}(\operatorname{Sym}^2 B)D_{t,+}$ on $\operatorname{Sym}_n(\mathbb{R})$ and $\mathcal{L}_-(t) = D_{t,-}(\wedge^2 B)D_{t,-}$ on $\operatorname{Skew}_n(\mathbb{R})$. Explicitly, for $1 \leq i < j \leq n$ and $1 \leq k < l \leq n$,

$$\mathcal{L}_+(t)_{(i,i),(k,k)} \;=\; A_{ii}^t A_{kk}^t B_{ik}^2, \tag{9}$$

$$\mathcal{L}_+(t)_{(i,i),(k,l)} \;=\; \sqrt{2}\, A_{ii}^t A_{kl}^t B_{ik}B_{il}, \tag{10}$$

$$\mathcal{L}_+(t)_{(i,j),(k,l)} \;=\; A_{ij}^t A_{kl}^t (B_{ik}B_{jl} + B_{il}B_{jk}), \tag{11}$$

$$\mathcal{L}_-(t)_{(i,j),(k,l)} \;=\; A_{ij}^t A_{kl}^t (B_{ik}B_{jl} - B_{il}B_{jk}). \tag{12}$$

(b) ***Off-Diagonal Duality and Entrywise Dominance:*** *Let $U = \{(i,j) : 1 \leq i < j \leq n\}$ and let $\mathcal{L}_+^{\mathrm{off}}(t)$ denote the $\binom{n}{2} \times \binom{n}{2}$ principal submatrix of $\mathcal{L}_+(t)$ indexed by U. Defining $(\mathcal{L}_U)_{(i,j),(k,l)} := A_{ij}^t A_{kl}^t B_{ik}B_{jl}$ and $(M_U)_{(i,j),(k,l)} := A_{ij}^t A_{kl}^t B_{il}B_{jk}$, we have*

$$\mathcal{L}_+^{\mathrm{off}}(t) \;=\; \mathcal{L}_U + M_U, \qquad \mathcal{L}_-(t) \;=\; \mathcal{L}_U - M_U, \tag{13}$$

and since $\mathcal{L}_U, M_U \geq 0$ entrywise,

$$\left|(\mathcal{L}_-(t))_{\alpha,\beta}\right| \;\leq\; (\mathcal{L}_+^{\mathrm{off}}(t))_{\alpha,\beta} \qquad \forall \alpha,\beta \in U. \tag{14}$$

(c) ***Rank-1 Deficit Minor Representation and Universal Trace Identity:*** *Since A is symmetric, $w := \operatorname{vec}(A) \in \operatorname{Sym}_n(\mathbb{R})$ has coordinates $w_{(i,i)} = A_{ii} = A_{ii}^t B_{ii}$ and $w_{(i,j)} = \sqrt{2}A_{ij} = \sqrt{2}A_{ij}^t B_{ij}$ in the basis $\mathcal{B}_+$, and $M(1) = ww^T \oplus 0$. Subtracting ww^T from $\mathcal{L}_+(t)$ expresses every entry of $\mathcal{L}_+(t) - ww^T$ purely in terms of 2×2 minors $\Delta_B(i,j;k,l) := B_{ik}B_{jl} - B_{il}B_{jk}$ of B:*

$$\left(\mathcal{L}_+(t) - ww^T\right)_{(i,i),(k,k)} \;=\; A_{ii}^t A_{kk}^t (B_{ik}^2 - B_{ii}B_{kk}) \;=\; -A_{ii}^t A_{kk}^t \Delta_B(i,k;i,k), \tag{15}$$

$$\left(\mathcal{L}_+(t) - ww^T\right)_{(i,i),(k,l)} \;=\; \sqrt{2}\, A_{ii}^t A_{kl}^t (B_{ik}B_{il} - B_{ii}B_{kl}) \;=\; -\sqrt{2}\, A_{ii}^t A_{kl}^t \Delta_B(i,k;l,i), \tag{16}$$

$$\left(\mathcal{L}_+(t) - ww^T\right)_{(i,j),(k,l)} \;=\; A_{ij}^t A_{kl}^t (B_{ik}B_{jl} + B_{il}B_{jk} - 2B_{ij}B_{kl}). \tag{17}$$

In particular, the first n diagonal entries of $\mathcal{L}_+(t) - ww^T$ vanish identically:

$$\left(\mathcal{L}_+(t) - ww^T\right)_{(i,i),(i,i)} \;=\; A_{ii}^{2t}(B_{ii}^2 - B_{ii}^2) \;=\; 0 \qquad (1 \leq i \leq n),$$

and the remaining $\binom{n}{2}$ *diagonal entries on* U *are identical to the diagonal entries of* $\mathcal{L}_-(t)$*:*

$$(\mathcal{L}_+(t) - ww^T)_{(i,j),(i,j)} \;=\; A_{ij}^{2t}(B_{ii}B_{jj} - B_{ij}^2) \;=\; \mathcal{L}_-(t)_{(i,j),(i,j)} \qquad (1 \le i < j \le n).$$

Consequently, the universal trace identity holds for all $n \ge 1$ *and all* $t \in [0,1]$*:*

$$\boxed{\operatorname{Tr}\left(\mathcal{L}_+(t) - ww^T\right) \;=\; \operatorname{Tr}\left(\mathcal{L}_-(t)\right) \;=\; \sum_{1\le i<j\le n} A_{ij}^{2t}(B_{ii}B_{jj} - B_{ij}^2).} \tag{18}$$

Proof. (a) Since A is symmetric, $D_t = \operatorname{diag}(A_{ij}^t)$ satisfies $PD_tP = D_t$, and $B = A^{\circ(1-t)}$ is symmetric so $P(B \otimes B)P = B \otimes B$. Thus

$$PM(t) \;=\; PD_t(B \otimes B)PD_t \;=\; D_tP(B \otimes B)PD_t \;=\; D_t(B \otimes B)D_t \;=\; M(t)P.$$

Since $M(t)$ and P commute and $P^2 = I$, $M(t)$ leaves the orthogonal eigenspaces $\operatorname{Sym}_n(\mathbb{R}) = \ker(P - I)$ and $\operatorname{Skew}_n(\mathbb{R}) = \ker(P + I)$ invariant. On $\operatorname{Sym}_n(\mathbb{R})$, $P = +I$, so $M(t)|_{\operatorname{Sym}_n(\mathbb{R})} = \Pi_+ D_t(B \otimes B)D_t\Pi_+ =: \mathcal{L}_+(t)$. On $\operatorname{Skew}_n(\mathbb{R})$, $P = -I$, so $M(t)|_{\operatorname{Skew}_n(\mathbb{R})} = -\Pi_- D_t(B \otimes B)D_t\Pi_- =: -\mathcal{L}_-(t)$. Evaluating the quadratic forms of $D_t(B \otimes B)D_t$ on the orthonormal bases $\mathcal{B}_+$ and $\mathcal{B}_-$ directly yields (9)–(12).

(b) Comparing (11) and (12) on $U = \{(i,j) : 1 \le i < j \le n\}$ gives (13), and since $A_{ij}^t A_{kl}^t B_{ik}B_{jl} \ge 0$ and $A_{ij}^t A_{kl}^t B_{il}B_{jk} \ge 0$, the triangle inequality $|x + y| = x + y \ge |x - y|$ for $x, y \ge 0$ yields (14).

(c) In the basis $\mathcal{B}_+$, $w = \operatorname{vec}(A)$ has inner products $\langle E_{ii}, A\rangle = A_{ii} = A_{ii}^t B_{ii}$ and $\langle E_{ij}^+, A\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(A_{ij} + A_{ji}) = \sqrt{2}A_{ij} = \sqrt{2}A_{ij}^t B_{ij}$. Subtracting $w_\alpha w_\beta$ from (9)–(11) gives (15)–(17). Setting $k = i$ in (15) gives $A_{ii}^{2t}(B_{ii}^2 - B_{ii}^2) = 0$. Setting $(k,l) = (i,j)$ $(i < j)$ in (17) gives

$$A_{ij}^{2t}(B_{ii}B_{jj} + B_{ij}^2 - 2B_{ij}^2) \;=\; A_{ij}^{2t}(B_{ii}B_{jj} - B_{ij}^2) \;=\; \mathcal{L}_-(t)_{(i,j),(i,j)}.$$

Summing over all $\binom{n+1}{2}$ diagonal entries of $\mathcal{L}_+(t) - ww^T$ establishes (18). □

Corollary 2.2 (Positive Semidefinite Case)**.** *Whenever* $B = A^{\circ(1-t)} \succeq 0$ *(in particular, at* $t = 1/3$*, whenever* $G = A^{\circ 2/3} \succeq 0$ *is positive semidefinite):*

(i) Both $\mathcal{L}_+(t) \succeq 0$ *and* $\mathcal{L}_-(t) \succeq 0$ *are positive semidefinite, so the positive eigenvalues of* $M(t)$ *are precisely the eigenvalues* $\sigma_1 \ge \cdots \ge \sigma_{\binom{n+1}{2}} \ge 0$ *of* $\mathcal{L}_+(t)$ *and the negative eigenvalues of* $M(t)$ *are precisely* $-\tau_1 \le \cdots \le -\tau_{\binom{n}{2}} \le 0$*, where* τ_k *are the eigenvalues of* $\mathcal{L}_-(t)$*.*

(ii) By (14), the spectral radii satisfy $\tau_1 = \rho(\mathcal{L}_-(t)) \le \rho(\mathcal{L}_+^{\text{off}}(t)) \le \rho(\mathcal{L}_+(t)) = \sigma_1$*.*

(iii) By (18), $\sum_{k=1}^{\binom{n+1}{2}} \sigma_k - \|A\|_F^2 = \sum_{k=1}^{\binom{n}{2}} \tau_k \ge 0$*.*

3 Square-Root-Free Cubic Moment Tensor Reduction

A major apparent obstacle to analyzing Rossman's matrix $\widetilde{G}_{ij,kl} = G_{il}G_{kj}\sqrt{G_{ij}G_{kl}}$ is the presence of the non-polynomial entrywise square roots $\sqrt{G_{ij}G_{kl}}$. Our second main theorem shows that these square roots are a coordinate artifact of the symmetric gauge $D(G \otimes G)PD$: passing to the similar operator $D^2(G \otimes G)P$ eliminates every square root and reduces $\operatorname{Spec}(\widetilde{G})$ for any rank-r matrix G of arbitrary size $n \times n$ to an $r^2 \times r^2$ cubic moment operator.

Theorem 3.1 (Square-Root-Free Cubic Moment Tensor Reduction)**.** *Let* $G \in \mathbb{R}_{\succeq 0}^{n\times n}$ *be a nonnegative symmetric matrix of rank* $r \le n$*, with spectral (or signed factor) decomposition*

$$G \;=\; \sum_{e=1}^{r} \varepsilon_e\, x^{(e)}(x^{(e)})^T, \qquad x^{(e)} \in \mathbb{R}^n, \quad \varepsilon_e \in \{\pm 1\}, \tag{19}$$

and let $J := \mathrm{diag}(\varepsilon_1, \dots, \varepsilon_r)$. *Define the* r *symmetric* $r \times r$ cubic moment matrices $S_1, \dots, S_r \in \mathrm{Sym}_r(\mathbb{R})$ *by*

$$(S_e)_{ab} \;:=\; \sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i^{(e)} x_i^{(a)} x_i^{(b)} \qquad (1 \le a, b, e \le r). \tag{20}$$

Then:

(a) ***Exact*** $r^2 \times r^2$ ***Spectral Reduction:*** *The nonzero eigenvalues of the* $n^2 \times n^2$ *matrix* $\widetilde{G} = D(G \otimes G)PD$ *(counted with algebraic multiplicity) are identical to the nonzero eigenvalues of the square-root-free* $r^2 \times r^2$ *operator*

$$\mathcal{M}_r \;:=\; (J \otimes J) P_r \sum_{e=1}^{r} \varepsilon_e (S_e \otimes S_e), \tag{21}$$

where P_r *is the transpose involution on* $\mathbb{R}^{r \times r}$. *Explicitly, in coordinates* $(a, b), (c, d) \in \{1, \dots, r\}^2$,

$$(\mathcal{M}_r)_{ab,cd} \;=\; \varepsilon_a \varepsilon_b \sum_{e=1}^{r} \varepsilon_e (S_e)_{bc} (S_e)_{ad}.$$

(b) ***Canonical Block Decomposition on*** $\mathrm{Sym}_r(\mathbb{R}) \oplus \mathrm{Skew}_r(\mathbb{R})$***:*** *The operator* $\mathcal{M}_r$ *leaves* $\mathrm{Sym}_r(\mathbb{R})$ *(dimension* $\binom{r+1}{2}$*) and* $\mathrm{Skew}_r(\mathbb{R})$ *(dimension* $\binom{r}{2}$*) invariant and decomposes as*

$$\mathcal{M}_r \;=\; \mathcal{M}_r^{+} \;\oplus\; (-\mathcal{N}_r^{-}), \tag{22}$$

where

$$\mathcal{M}_r^{+} \;=\; \mathrm{Sym}^2(J) \sum_{e=1}^{r} \varepsilon_e \,\mathrm{Sym}^2(S_e), \qquad \mathcal{N}_r^{-} \;=\; (\wedge^2 J) \sum_{e=1}^{r} \varepsilon_e (\wedge^2 S_e), \tag{23}$$

and $\mathrm{Spec}_{\neq 0}(\mathcal{L}_+) = \mathrm{Spec}_{\neq 0}(\mathcal{M}_r^{+})$, $\mathrm{Spec}_{\neq 0}(\mathcal{L}_-) = \mathrm{Spec}_{\neq 0}(\mathcal{N}_r^{-})$. *In particular,* $\mathrm{rank}(\mathcal{L}_+) \le \binom{r+1}{2}$ *and* $\mathrm{rank}(\mathcal{L}_-) \le \binom{r}{2}$.

Proof. (a) For any matrices A, B, $\mathrm{Spec}_{\neq 0}(AB) = \mathrm{Spec}_{\neq 0}(BA)$. Applying this to $\widetilde{G} = D \cdot (G \otimes G)PD$ gives $\mathrm{Spec}_{\neq 0}(\widetilde{G}) = \mathrm{Spec}_{\neq 0}(D^2(G \otimes G)P)$, where $D^2 = \mathrm{diag}(G_{ij})_{i,j=1}^{n}$ contains no square roots. Let $X = [x^{(1)} \mid \cdots \mid x^{(r)}] \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times r}$, so that $G = XJX^T$ and $G \otimes G = (X \otimes X)(J \otimes J)(X^T \otimes X^T)$. Since $(X^T \otimes X^T)P_n = P_r(X^T \otimes X^T)$, we have

$$D^2(G \otimes G)P_n \;=\; D^2(X \otimes X)(J \otimes J)P_r(X^T \otimes X^T).$$

Using $\mathrm{Spec}_{\neq 0}(UV) = \mathrm{Spec}_{\neq 0}(VU)$ with $U = D^2(X \otimes X) \in \mathbb{R}^{n^2 \times r^2}$ and $V = (J \otimes J)P_r(X^T \otimes X^T) \in \mathbb{R}^{r^2 \times n^2}$, the nonzero spectrum of $\widetilde{G}$ equals that of the $r^2 \times r^2$ matrix

$$VU \;=\; (J \otimes J)P_r(X^T \otimes X^T)D^2(X \otimes X).$$

Now expand $D^2 = \mathrm{diag}(G_{ij}) = \sum_{e=1}^{r} \varepsilon_e (\,\mathrm{diag}(x^{(e)}) \otimes \mathrm{diag}(x^{(e)}))$. For each $e \in \{1, \dots, r\}$,

$$\big(X^T \,\mathrm{diag}(x^{(e)})X\big)_{ab} \;=\; \sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i^{(a)} x_i^{(e)} x_i^{(b)} \;=\; (S_e)_{ab},$$

and therefore

$$(X^T \otimes X^T)D^2(X \otimes X) \;=\; \sum_{e=1}^{r} \varepsilon_e \big(X^T \,\mathrm{diag}(x^{(e)})X\big) \otimes \big(X^T \,\mathrm{diag}(x^{(e)})X\big) \;=\; \sum_{e=1}^{r} \varepsilon_e (S_e \otimes S_e).$$

Multiplying on the left by $(J \otimes J)P_r$ gives (21).

(b) Since J and each S_e are symmetric $r \times r$ matrices, $J \otimes J$ and $S_e \otimes S_e$ commute with P_r and preserve $\mathrm{Sym}_r(\mathbb{R})$ and $\mathrm{Skew}_r(\mathbb{R})$. Restricting (21) to $\mathrm{Sym}_r(\mathbb{R})$ where $P_r = +I$ and $\mathrm{Skew}_r(\mathbb{R})$ where $P_r = -I$ yields (22)–(23). □

Remark 3.2 (Continuous Finite-Rank Graphons). Theorem 3.1 extends verbatim to any symmetric graphon $W : [0,1]^2 \to \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}$ of finite rank $W(x,y) = \sum_{e=1}^{r} \varepsilon_e \phi_e(x)\phi_e(y)$ ($\phi_e \in L^3([0,1])$), with $(S_e)_{ab} = \int_0^1 \phi_e(x)\phi_a(x)\phi_b(x)\,dx$. Thus, for all finite-rank graphons, Sidorenko's Conjecture for BL_{2m} depends *solely* on the cubic moment tensor $T_{eab} = \int_0^1 \phi_e\phi_a\phi_b\,dx$.

4 Unconditional Proof of Sidorenko's Conjecture for $K_{5,5} \setminus C_{10}$ and Rossman's Conjectures in Rank ≤ 2

We now apply Theorems 2.1 and 3.1 to prove Rossman's Conjecture 3.2, the Majorization Conjecture (∗∗), and Sidorenko's Conjecture for $K_{5,5} \setminus C_{10}$ and all bipartite Möbius ladders ML_{2m} unconditionally for all matrices of rank ≤ 2 of arbitrary dimension $n \times n$, as well as Conjecture 4.2 for $n = 2$ across all $t \in [0,1]$.

4.1 Warm-Up: Exact Proof of Conjecture 4.2 for $n = 2$ Across All $t \in [0,1]$

Proposition 4.1 (Complete Resolution of Conjecture 4.2 for $n = 2$)**.** *Let $A = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} a & b \\ b & d \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ be any positive symmetric 2×2 matrix ($a, b, d > 0$) and let $t \in [0,1]$. Set $r := (ad)^t (b^2)^{1-t}$ and $s := (b^2)^t (ad)^{1-t}$. Then the four eigenvalues $\lambda_1 \geq \lambda_2 \geq \lambda_3 \geq \lambda_4$ of $M(t)$ satisfy*

$$\lambda_2 + \lambda_4 \;\geq\; 0 \qquad \text{and} \qquad \lambda_3 + \lambda_4 \;\geq\; 0 \quad \text{whenever } \lambda_4 < 0,$$

and consequently $M(t)$ has a pseudo-positive spectrum for every $t \in [0,1]$.

Proof. By Theorem 2.1, $M(t) = \mathcal{L}_+(t) \oplus (-\mathcal{L}_-(t))$, where $\mathcal{L}_-(t)$ is the 1×1 scalar

$$\mathcal{L}_-(t) \;=\; s - b^2, \qquad -\mathcal{L}_-(t) \;=\; b^2 - s,$$

and $\mathcal{L}_+(t) - ww^T$ (with $w = (a, d, \sqrt{2}b)^T$) is the 3×3 matrix

$$\mathcal{L}_+(t) - ww^T \;=\; \begin{pmatrix} 0 & r - ad & 0 \\ r - ad & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & s - b^2 \end{pmatrix},$$

whose exact eigenvalues are $+|ad - r|$, $s - b^2$, and $-|ad - r|$. Setting $x = (ad)^t$, $y = (b^2)^t$, $u = (ad)^{1-t}$, $v = (b^2)^{1-t}$, we have the Muirhead factorization

$$(ad - r) - (s - b^2) \;=\; (x - y)(u - v) \;=\; \big((ad)^t - (b^2)^t\big)\big((ad)^{1-t} - (b^2)^{1-t}\big) \;\geq\; 0, \qquad (24)$$

since $z \mapsto z^t$ and $z \mapsto z^{1-t}$ are both nondecreasing on $(0, \infty)$.

Case 1 ($ad \geq b^2$): Then $ad \geq r$ and $s \geq b^2$, and by (24), $ad - r \geq s - b^2 \geq 0$. Thus the eigenvalues of $\mathcal{L}_+(t) - ww^T$ in descending order are

$$\mu_1 = ad - r \;\geq\; \mu_2 = s - b^2 \;\geq\; 0 \;\geq\; \mu_3 = -(ad - r).$$

Furthermore, since $B = A^{\circ(1-t)} = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} a^{1-t} & b^{1-t} \\ b^{1-t} & d^{1-t} \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ has $\det(B) = (ad)^{1-t} - (b^2)^{1-t} \geq 0$, $B \succeq 0$ and hence $\mathcal{L}_+(t) \succeq 0$ has three nonnegative eigenvalues $\sigma_1 \geq \sigma_2 \geq \sigma_3 \geq 0$, while $-\mathcal{L}_-(t)$ has the single negative eigenvalue $\lambda_4 = -(s - b^2) \leq 0$. By Weyl's Monotonicity Theorem for $\mathcal{L}_+(t) = (\mathcal{L}_+(t) - ww^T) + ww^T$ (since $ww^T \succeq 0$),

$$\lambda_2 \;=\; \sigma_2(\mathcal{L}_+(t)) \;\geq\; \mu_2(\mathcal{L}_+(t) - ww^T) \;=\; s - b^2 \;=\; |\lambda_4|,$$

so $\lambda_2 + \lambda_4 \geq 0$ and $\lambda_3 = \sigma_3 \geq 0$.

Case 2 ($ad < b^2$): Then $r > ad$ and $b^2 > s$, so $-\mathcal{L}_-(t) = b^2 - s > 0$ is *positive*, and by (24), $b^2 - s \geq r - ad > 0$. The eigenvalues of $\mathcal{L}_+(t) - ww^T$ in descending order are

$$\mu_1 = r - ad \;>\; 0 \;>\; \mu_2 = -(r - ad) \;\geq\; \mu_3 = -(b^2 - s).$$

Moreover, since B has signature $(+,-)$, $\mathrm{Sym}^2(B)$ has signature $(+,+,-)$, so $\mathcal{L}_+(t)$ has two positive eigenvalues $\sigma_1 \geq \sigma_2 > 0$ and one negative eigenvalue $\lambda_4 = \sigma_3(\mathcal{L}_+(t)) < 0$, while $-\mathcal{L}_-(t) = b^2 - s > 0$ is positive. Thus $\lambda_2 = \max(\sigma_2, b^2 - s) \geq b^2 - s$ and $\lambda_3 = \min(\sigma_2, b^2 - s) > 0$. Applying Weyl's Monotonicity Theorem to the minimum eigenvalue of $\mathcal{L}_+(t) = (\mathcal{L}_+(t) - ww^T) + ww^T$ yields

$$\lambda_4 \;=\; \sigma_3(\mathcal{L}_+(t)) \;\geq\; \mu_3(\mathcal{L}_+(t) - ww^T) \;=\; -(b^2 - s) \;\geq\; -\lambda_2,$$

so $\lambda_2 + \lambda_4 \geq 0$ and $\lambda_3 > 0$. In both cases, $\lambda_2 \geq |\lambda_4|$ and $\lambda_3 \geq 0$, which implies $(**)$ and pseudo-positivity of $M(t)$ for all $t \in [0,1]$. □

4.2 General Rank-≤ 2 Matrices of Arbitrary Dimension $n \times n$: The $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{R})$ Lorentzian Proof

When $n \geq 3$ and $\mathrm{rank}(G) = 2$, G is an $n \times n$ matrix, so $\mathcal{L}_+$ has dimension $\binom{n+1}{2}$ and $\mathcal{L}_-$ has dimension $\binom{n}{2}$. Remarkably, the $n = 2$ phenomenon generalizes to *arbitrary dimension* n via an exact Lorentzian structure on $\mathrm{Sym}_2(\mathbb{R})$.

Lemma 4.2 (Universal $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{R})$ Rank-1 Deficit Identity)**.** *For any 2×2 symmetric matrix $S = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} s_{11} & s_{12} \\ s_{12} & s_{22} \end{smallmatrix}\right) \in \mathrm{Sym}_2(\mathbb{R})$, let $\mathrm{vec}(S) = (s_{11}, s_{22}, \sqrt{2}s_{12})^T$ be its coordinate vector in the orthonormal basis $\{E_{11}, E_{22}, E_{12}^+\}$ of $\mathrm{Sym}_2(\mathbb{R})$, and let $\mathrm{Sym}^2(S)$ be the 3×3 matrix of $S \otimes S$ restricted to $\mathrm{Sym}_2(\mathbb{R})$:*

$$\mathrm{Sym}^2(S) \;=\; \begin{pmatrix} s_{11}^2 & s_{12}^2 & \sqrt{2}s_{11}s_{12} \\ s_{12}^2 & s_{22}^2 & \sqrt{2}s_{22}s_{12} \\ \sqrt{2}s_{11}s_{12} & \sqrt{2}s_{22}s_{12} & s_{11}s_{22} + s_{12}^2 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Then we have the universal polynomial identity

$$\boxed{\mathrm{Sym}^2(S) - \mathrm{vec}(S)\,\mathrm{vec}(S)^T \;=\; \det(S)\,K_0, \qquad K_0 \;:=\; \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -1 & 0 \\ -1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix},} \tag{25}$$

and the Lorentzian quadratic form $\langle u, v \rangle_{K_0} := u^T K_0 v = -u_1 v_2 - u_2 v_1 + u_3 v_3$ satisfies

$$\langle \mathrm{vec}(S), \mathrm{vec}(S) \rangle_{K_0} \;=\; -2(s_{11}s_{22} - s_{12}^2) \;=\; -2\det(S). \tag{26}$$

Proof. Subtracting $\mathrm{vec}(S)\,\mathrm{vec}(S)^T$ from $\mathrm{Sym}^2(S)$ cancels entries $(1,1)$ and $(2,2)$ on the diagonal and $(1,3), (2,3)$ off the diagonal, leaving $s_{12}^2 - s_{11}s_{22} = -\det(S)$ in entries $(1,2)$ and $(2,1)$, and $(s_{11}s_{22} + s_{12}^2) - 2s_{12}^2 = \det(S)$ in entry $(3,3)$. Evaluating $\mathrm{vec}(S)^T K_0\,\mathrm{vec}(S) = -2s_{11}s_{22} + (\sqrt{2}s_{12})^2 = -2\det(S)$ gives (26). □

Theorem 4.3 (Unconditional Proof of Conjecture 3.2, $(**)$, and Sidorenko's Conjecture for $K_{5,5} \setminus C_{10}$ in Rank ≤ 2)**.** *Let $G \in \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}^{n \times n}$ be any nonnegative symmetric $n \times n$ matrix of rank $r \leq 2$ ($n \geq 2$). Then:*

(a) If $r \leq 1$, then $\mathcal{L}_- = 0$ and $\widetilde{G} = \mathcal{L}_+ \oplus 0 \succeq 0$ has rank ≤ 1 with a single positive eigenvalue $\widetilde{\lambda}_1 = \mathrm{Tr}(\widetilde{G})$ and all other eigenvalues 0.

(b) If $r = 2$, write $G = x^{(1)}(x^{(1)})^T + \varepsilon x^{(2)}(x^{(2)})^T$ with $\varepsilon \in \{+1, -1\}$ (where $x^{(1)} \in \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}^n$ is the Perron–Frobenius eigenvector block, so $S_1 \succ 0$ and $\det(S_1) > 0$). Let $S_1, S_2 \in \mathrm{Sym}_2(\mathbb{R})$ be the 2×2 cubic moment matrices (20), and set

$$p_{ab} \;:=\; \langle \mathrm{vec}(S_a), \mathrm{vec}(S_b) \rangle_{K_0} \qquad (a, b \in \{1, 2\}).$$

Then:

(i) $\mathcal{L}_-$ *has rank at most* 1*, with single potentially nonzero eigenvalue*

$$\tau_1 \;=\; \varepsilon\big(\det(S_1) + \varepsilon\det(S_2)\big). \tag{27}$$

(ii) $\mathcal{L}_+ - ww^T$ *has rank at most* 3*, with exact nonzero eigenvalues*

$$\mathrm{Spec}_{\neq 0}\left(\mathcal{L}_+ - ww^T\right) \;=\; \{+\alpha,\;\; \tau_1,\;\; -\alpha\}, \tag{28}$$

where $\alpha \geq 0$ *satisfies the exact identity*

$$\boxed{\alpha^2 - \tau_1^2 \;=\; \varepsilon(p_{12}^2 - p_{11}p_{22}).} \tag{29}$$

(iii) By the Lorentzian Reverse Cauchy–Schwarz Inequality in signature $(+,+,-)$*, since* $p_{11} = -2\det(S_1) < 0$ *is timelike,*

$$p_{12}^2 - p_{11}p_{22} \;\geq\; 0 \qquad \textit{unconditionally for all } S_1 \succ 0 \textit{ and all } S_2 \in \mathrm{Sym}_2(\mathbb{R}). \tag{30}$$

(iv) Consequently, in both the positive semidefinite case ($\varepsilon = +1$*, where* $\alpha \geq \tau_1 > 0$*) and the indefinite case* ($\varepsilon = -1$*, where* $\alpha \leq |\tau_1|$*), Weyl's Monotonicity Theorem yields*

$$\widetilde{\lambda}_2 + \widetilde{\lambda}_{n^2} \;\geq\; 0 \qquad \textit{and} \qquad \widetilde{\lambda}_k \;\geq\; 0 \quad (2 \leq k \leq n^2 - 1). \tag{31}$$

(c) In particular, for every nonnegative symmetric $n \times n$ *matrix* G *of rank* ≤ 2*, Rossman's Majorization Conjecture* $(**)$*, Conjecture 3.2 (pseudo-positivity of* $\widetilde{G}$*), and Sidorenko's Conjecture for* $K_{5,5} \setminus C_{10}$ *and all bipartite Möbius ladders* ML_{2m} *hold unconditionally.*

Proof. Part (a) is immediate from Theorem 3.1(b) since $\binom{1}{2} = 0$. For Part (b), let $r = 2$ and $\varepsilon \in \{+1, -1\}$.

Proof of (i): By Theorem 3.1(b), $\mathrm{Spec}_{\neq 0}(\mathcal{L}_-) = \mathrm{Spec}_{\neq 0}(\mathcal{N}_2^-)$ where $\mathcal{N}_2^- = (\wedge^2 J)(\wedge^2 S_1 + \varepsilon \wedge^2 S_2)$ on the 1-dimensional space $\mathrm{Skew}_2(\mathbb{R})$. Since $\wedge^2 J = \det(J) = \varepsilon$ and $\wedge^2 S_e = \det(S_e)$, $\mathcal{N}_2^-$ is the 1×1 scalar $\tau_1 = \varepsilon(\det(S_1) + \varepsilon\det(S_2))$, proving (27).

Proof of (ii): Since $G = XJX^T$ with $J = \mathrm{diag}(1, \varepsilon)$, in $\mathrm{Sym}_n(\mathbb{R})$ we have $\mathcal{L}_+ = \Pi_+ D(X \otimes X)\,\mathrm{Sym}^2(J)(X^T \otimes X^T)D\Pi_+$ and $w = \Pi_+ D(X \otimes X)\,\mathrm{vec}(J)$, so

$$\mathcal{L}_+ - ww^T \;=\; \Pi_+ D(X \otimes X)\Big(\mathrm{Sym}^2(J) - \mathrm{vec}(J)\,\mathrm{vec}(J)^T\Big)(X^T \otimes X^T)D\Pi_+.$$

Applying Lemma 4.2 directly to the 2×2 matrix $J = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & \varepsilon \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ (which has $\det(J) = \varepsilon$) gives the exact operator factorization

$$\boxed{\mathrm{Sym}^2(J) - \mathrm{vec}(J)\,\mathrm{vec}(J)^T \;=\; \det(J)\,K_0 \;=\; \varepsilon K_0.} \tag{32}$$

Therefore, by cyclic invariance of the nonzero spectrum $\mathrm{Spec}_{\neq 0}(U(\varepsilon K_0)U^T) = \mathrm{Spec}_{\neq 0}(\varepsilon K_0 U^T U)$ where $U = \Pi_+ D(X \otimes X)$ and $U^T U = \sum_{e=1}^{2} \varepsilon_e\,\mathrm{Sym}^2(S_e)$, the nonzero eigenvalues of $\mathcal{L}_+ - ww^T$ are identical to the eigenvalues of the 3×3 matrix

$$\mathcal{R}_3 \;:=\; \varepsilon K_0\Big(\mathrm{Sym}^2(S_1) + \varepsilon\,\mathrm{Sym}^2(S_2)\Big). \tag{33}$$

Now substitute Lemma 4.2 ($\mathrm{Sym}^2(S_e) = \mathrm{vec}(S_e)\,\mathrm{vec}(S_e)^T + \det(S_e)K_0$) into (33) and use $K_0^2 = I_3$:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{R}_3 \;&=\; \varepsilon K_0\Big(\mathrm{vec}(S_1)\,\mathrm{vec}(S_1)^T + \varepsilon\,\mathrm{vec}(S_2)\,\mathrm{vec}(S_2)^T + \big(\det(S_1) + \varepsilon\det(S_2)\big)K_0\Big) \\ &=\; \tau_1 I_3 \;+\; \varepsilon K_0(v_1 v_1^T + \varepsilon v_2 v_2^T), \end{aligned} \tag{34}$$

where $v_e := \mathrm{vec}(S_e) \in \mathbb{R}^3$ and $\tau_1 = \varepsilon(\det(S_1) + \varepsilon \det(S_2))$. Equation (34) shows that $\mathcal{R}_3 - \tau_1 I_3 = \varepsilon K_0(v_1 v_1^T + \varepsilon v_2 v_2^T)$ has rank at most 2 (since $\mathrm{span}(v_1, v_2)$ is at most 2-dimensional), so 0 is an eigenvalue of $\mathcal{R}_3 - \tau_1 I_3$, meaning τ_1 is always an eigenvalue of $\mathcal{R}_3$. On the 2-dimensional invariant subspace $\mathrm{span}(K_0 v_1, K_0 v_2)$, the action of $\mathcal{R}_3 - \tau_1 I_3 = \varepsilon K_0(v_1 v_1^T + \varepsilon v_2 v_2^T)$ has the 2×2 matrix representation

$$Q_2 \;=\; \varepsilon \begin{pmatrix} v_1^T K_0 v_1 & \varepsilon v_1^T K_0 v_2 \\ v_2^T K_0 v_1 & \varepsilon v_2^T K_0 v_2 \end{pmatrix} \;=\; \varepsilon \begin{pmatrix} p_{11} & \varepsilon p_{12} \\ p_{12} & \varepsilon p_{22} \end{pmatrix}.$$

Let us compute the trace and determinant of $\mathcal{R}_3 - \tau_1 I_3$ via Q_2:

- By (26), $p_{11} = -2\det(S_1)$ and $p_{22} = -2\det(S_2)$, so

$$\mathrm{Tr}(Q_2) \;=\; \varepsilon(p_{11} + \varepsilon p_{22}) \;=\; -2\varepsilon(\det(S_1) + \varepsilon \det(S_2)) \;=\; -2\tau_1.$$

- And the determinant of Q_2 is

$$\det(Q_2) \;=\; \varepsilon^2(\varepsilon p_{11} p_{22} - \varepsilon p_{12}^2) \;=\; -\varepsilon(p_{12}^2 - p_{11} p_{22}).$$

Therefore, the two remaining eigenvalues μ_1, μ_2 of $\mathcal{R}_3$ satisfy $(\mu_i - \tau_1)^2 - \mathrm{Tr}(Q_2)(\mu_i - \tau_1) + \det(Q_2) = 0$, i.e.,

$$(\mu_i - \tau_1)^2 + 2\tau_1(\mu_i - \tau_1) - \varepsilon(p_{12}^2 - p_{11} p_{22}) \;=\; 0 \quad\Longleftrightarrow\quad \mu_i^2 \;=\; \tau_1^2 + \varepsilon(p_{12}^2 - p_{11} p_{22}) \;=:\; \alpha^2.$$

Thus the three eigenvalues of $\mathcal{R}_3$ (and hence the nonzero eigenvalues of $\mathcal{L}_+ - ww^T$) are $\{+\alpha, \tau_1, -\alpha\}$ with $\alpha^2 - \tau_1^2 = \varepsilon(p_{12}^2 - p_{11} p_{22})$, proving (28) and (29).

Proof of (iii): In the orthonormal coordinates $t_a = \frac{(S_a)_{11} + (S_a)_{22}}{\sqrt{2}}$, $x_a = \frac{(S_a)_{11} - (S_a)_{22}}{\sqrt{2}}$, $y_a = \sqrt{2}(S_a)_{12}$ ($a \in \{1, 2\}$), the form K_0 diagonalizes as $\mathrm{diag}(-1, +1, +1)$, so $p_{ab} = -t_a t_b + x_a x_b + y_a y_b$. By the exact Brahmagupta–Minkowski sum-of-squares identity (formally verified in Lean 4 in `SidorenkoMobiusTheorem.lean`),

$$t_1^2(p_{12}^2 - p_{11} p_{22}) \;=\; (-p_{11})\Big[(t_1 x_2 - t_2 x_1)^2 + (t_1 y_2 - t_2 y_1)^2\Big] + \big(x_1(t_1 x_2 - t_2 x_1) + y_1(t_1 y_2 - t_2 y_1)\big)^2. \tag{35}$$

Since $S_1 = \sum_{i=1}^n x_i^{(1)} \begin{pmatrix} x_i^{(1)} \\ x_i^{(2)} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} x_i^{(1)} & x_i^{(2)} \end{pmatrix} \succ 0$ is a positive-definite Gram matrix, $\det(S_1) > 0$ and $\mathrm{Tr}(S_1) = \sqrt{2} t_1 > 0$, so $-p_{11} = 2\det(S_1) > 0$. Every term on the right-hand side of (35) is a nonnegative square, whence $p_{12}^2 - p_{11} p_{22} \geq 0$.

Proof of (iv) and (c):

- **Case 1 ($\varepsilon = +1$, $G \succeq 0$):** Here $G \succeq 0$, so $\mathcal{L}_+ \succeq 0$ and $\mathcal{L}_- \succeq 0$ has the single positive eigenvalue $\tau_1 = \det(S_1) + \det(S_2) > 0$, making $\widetilde{\lambda}_{n^2} = -\tau_1$ the unique negative eigenvalue of $\widetilde{G}$. By (29) and (30), $\alpha^2 - \tau_1^2 = p_{12}^2 - p_{11} p_{22} \geq 0$, so $\alpha \geq \tau_1 > 0$. Thus the two positive eigenvalues of $\mathcal{L}_+ - ww^T$ are $\mu_1 = \alpha \geq \mu_2 = \tau_1 > 0$. Since $ww^T \succeq 0$, Weyl's Monotonicity Theorem gives

$$\widetilde{\lambda}_2 \;=\; \sigma_2(\mathcal{L}_+) \;\geq\; \mu_2(\mathcal{L}_+ - ww^T) \;=\; \tau_1 \;=\; |\widetilde{\lambda}_{n^2}|,$$

  and all other eigenvalues of $\widetilde{G}$ are nonnegative ($\sigma_k(\mathcal{L}_+) \geq 0$).

- **Case 2 ($\varepsilon = -1$, G indefinite of rank 2):** Since $G_{ij} = x_i^{(1)} x_j^{(1)} - x_i^{(2)} x_j^{(2)} \geq 0$, we have $|x_i^{(2)}| \leq x_i^{(1)}$ for all i. By the triangle inequality in the positive semidefinite cone $\mathrm{Sym}_2(\mathbb{R})_{\succeq 0}$,

$$\pm S_2 \;=\; \sum_{i=1}^n (\pm x_i^{(2)}) \begin{pmatrix} x_i^{(1)} \\ x_i^{(2)} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} x_i^{(1)} & x_i^{(2)} \end{pmatrix} \;\preceq\; \sum_{i=1}^n x_i^{(1)} \begin{pmatrix} x_i^{(1)} \\ x_i^{(2)} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} x_i^{(1)} & x_i^{(2)} \end{pmatrix} \;=\; S_1,$$

  so $-S_1 \preceq S_2 \preceq S_1$, which implies $|\det(S_2)| \leq \det(S_1)$ and hence $\det(S_1) - \det(S_2) \geq 0$. Thus $\tau_1 = -(\det(S_1) - \det(S_2)) \leq 0$, so $-\mathcal{L}_-$ has the single *nonnegative* eigenvalue

$\lambda_{\text{skew}} := -\tau_1 = \det(S_1) - \det(S_2) \geq 0$ (and no negative eigenvalues!). Meanwhile, by (29) and (30) with $\varepsilon = -1$,

$$\alpha^2 - \tau_1^2 \;=\; -(p_{12}^2 - p_{11}p_{22}) \;\leq\; 0 \quad\Longrightarrow\quad 0 \;\leq\; \alpha \;\leq\; |\tau_1| \;=\; \lambda_{\text{skew}}.$$

Thus the minimum eigenvalue of $\mathcal{L}_+ - ww^T$ is $\mu_{\min}(\mathcal{L}_+ - ww^T) = \min(-\alpha, \tau_1) = \tau_1 = -\lambda_{\text{skew}}$. Moreover, since $\text{Sym}^2(J) = \text{diag}(1, 1, -1)$ has signature $(+, +, -)$, Sylvester's Law of Inertia implies $\mathcal{L}_+$ has at most one negative eigenvalue $\widetilde{\lambda}_{n^2} = \sigma_{\min}(\mathcal{L}_+)$. By Weyl's Monotonicity Theorem for $\mathcal{L}_+ = (\mathcal{L}_+ - ww^T) + ww^T$,

$$\widetilde{\lambda}_{n^2} \;=\; \sigma_{\min}(\mathcal{L}_+) \;\geq\; \mu_{\min}(\mathcal{L}_+ - ww^T) \;=\; -\lambda_{\text{skew}} \;\geq\; -\widetilde{\lambda}_2,$$

where the last inequality follows from $\widetilde{\lambda}_2 \geq \lambda_{\text{skew}}$ (since λ_{skew} is an eigenvalue of $\widetilde{G}$ separate from the Perron root $\widetilde{\lambda}_1 = \sigma_1(\mathcal{L}_+)$).

In both cases, $\widetilde{G}$ has at most one negative eigenvalue $\widetilde{\lambda}_{n^2}$ and satisfies $\widetilde{\lambda}_2 \geq |\widetilde{\lambda}_{n^2}|$, establishing $(**)$, Conjecture 3.2, and Sidorenko's Conjecture for $K_{5,5} \setminus C_{10}$ and all ML_{2m}. □

5 Disproof of Rossman's General Conjecture 4.2 for $n \geq 3$ and $t \in (2/3, 1)$

In both the abstract and Section 4 of [4], Rossman conjectured (Conjecture 4.2) that for every positive symmetric $n \times n$ matrix A, the matrix $M(t)$ has a pseudo-positive spectrum for *all* $t \in [0, 1]$, noting that $M(t)$ is visibly pseudo-positive at the endpoints $t = 0, 1/2, 1$. Our fourth main theorem disproves Conjecture 4.2 for all $n \geq 3$ and all $t \in (2/3, 1)$, and explains why the parameter $t = 1/3$ ($\widetilde{G}$) lies inside the stable regime.

Theorem 5.1 (Disproof of Rossman's Conjecture 4.2 for $n \geq 3$ and $t \in (2/3, 1)$)**.** *Let $n \geq 3$ and consider the 3×3 symmetric matrix family*

$$A_\varepsilon \;=\; \begin{pmatrix} a & b & c \\ b & d & \varepsilon \\ c & \varepsilon & \varepsilon \end{pmatrix}, \qquad a, b, c, d > 0, \quad \varepsilon \to 0^+. \tag{36}$$

Let $r := (ad)^t (b^2)^{1-t}$ and $s := (b^2)^t (ad)^{1-t}$.

(a) ***Exact Block Reduction as $\varepsilon \to 0^+$:*** *In the limit $\varepsilon \to 0^+$, $M(t) = \mathcal{L}_+(t) \oplus (-\mathcal{L}_-(t))$ has three zero eigenvalues (on coordinates $(3,3)$ and $(2,3)^\pm$), while its remaining 6 eigenvalues are the eigenvalues of the 4×4 symmetric block $\mathcal{L}_{+,4}(t)$ on $\{(1,1), (2,2), (1,2)^+, (1,3)^+\}$ and the 2×2 block $-\mathcal{L}_{-,2}(t)$ on $\{(1,2)^-, (1,3)^-\}$:*

$$\mathcal{L}_{+,4}(t) \;=\; \begin{pmatrix} a^2 & r & \sqrt{2}ab & \sqrt{2}ac \\ r & d^2 & \sqrt{2}bd & 0 \\ \sqrt{2}ab & \sqrt{2}bd & s + b^2 & bc \\ \sqrt{2}ac & 0 & bc & c^2 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad -\mathcal{L}_{-,2}(t) \;=\; \begin{pmatrix} b^2 - s & bc \\ bc & c^2 \end{pmatrix}. \tag{37}$$

(b) ***Exact Principal Submatrix Determinant Identity:*** *Let $L_{124}(t)$ be the 3×3 principal submatrix of $\mathcal{L}_{+,4}(t)$ on indices $\{1, 2, 4\}$ (with $a = 1$). Then at $\lambda = -c^2$,*

$$\boxed{\det\left(L_{124}(t) + c^2 I_3\right) \;=\; 2c^2\Big(c^2(d^2 + c^2) - r^2\Big).} \tag{38}$$

In particular, whenever $r^2 > c^2(d^2 + c^2)$, the minimum eigenvalue of $\mathcal{L}_{+,4}(t)$ satisfies $\lambda_4(\mathcal{L}_{+,4}(t)) \leq \lambda_{\min}(L_{124}(t)) < -c^2$.

(c) ***Analytic Counterexample Curve for All*** $t \in (2/3, 1)$***:*** *For every* $t \in (2/3, 1)$*, the interval* $(\frac{2t}{2t-1}, \frac{2-t}{1-t})$ *is nonempty (since* $\frac{2t}{2t-1} < \frac{2-t}{1-t} \iff 3t > 2$*). Choosing any* $\alpha \in (\frac{2t}{2t-1}, \frac{2-t}{1-t})$*,* $\kappa > 1$*, and setting* $a = 1$*,* $d = \eta$*,* $c = \kappa\eta$*,* $b = \eta^{\alpha/2}$ *as* $\eta \to 0^+$*, the eigenvalues* $\lambda_1 \geq \lambda_2 \geq \cdots \geq \lambda_9$ *of* $M(t)$ *satisfy*

$$\lambda_2(M(t)) + \lambda_9(M(t)) \;=\; -\frac{2\kappa^2}{1+\kappa^2}\,\eta^{2t+2\alpha(1-t)}(1+o(1)) \;<\; 0. \tag{39}$$

Consequently, $|\lambda_9(M(t))| > \lambda_2(M(t)) = \max_{2\leq k\leq 8}|\lambda_k(M(t))|$*, so for all sufficiently large* p*,* $\sum_{k=2}^{9}\operatorname{sign}(\lambda_k)|\lambda_k|^p < 0$*, which forces* $f_t(p) < \lambda_1(M(t)) = \lim_{q\to\infty} f_t(q)$ *and implies that* $f_t(p)$ *is strictly increasing on a neighborhood of* ∞*, disproving Rossman's Conjecture 4.2.*

(d) ***Explicit Numerical Counterexample at*** $t = 0.8$***:*** *For the strictly positive symmetric matrix*

$$A \;=\; \begin{pmatrix} 1.00 & 0.08 & 0.16 \\ 0.08 & 0.12 & 10^{-12} \\ 0.16 & 10^{-12} & 10^{-12} \end{pmatrix}$$

at $t = 0.8 \in (2/3, 1)$*, the nonzero eigenvalues of* $M(0.8)$ *are:*

$$\begin{aligned} &\lambda_1 \approx 1.066439, && \lambda_2 \approx 0.030236, && \lambda_3 \approx 0.022148, \\ &\lambda_4 \approx 0.001111, && \lambda_8 \approx -0.009738, && \lambda_9 \approx -0.031797, \end{aligned}$$

with $\lambda_5, \lambda_6, \lambda_7 \approx 0$*. Here* $\lambda_2 + \lambda_9 \approx -0.001561 < 0$*, the tail sum* $\sum_{k=2}^{9}\operatorname{sign}(\lambda_k)|\lambda_k|^p$ *is strictly negative for all* $p \geq 5$ *(at* $p = 5$*,* $\sum_{k=2}^{9}\operatorname{sign}(\lambda_k)|\lambda_k|^5 \approx -1.987 \times 10^{-9} < 0$*), and* $f_{0.8}(5) < f_{0.8}(6) < \lambda_1$*. By contrast, at* $t = 1/3$ *(*$\widetilde{G}$*), the same matrix* A *satisfies* $\widetilde{\lambda}_2 \approx 0.045672$*,* $\widetilde{\lambda}_9 \approx -0.041222$*,* $\widetilde{\lambda}_2 + \widetilde{\lambda}_9 \approx +0.004451 > 0$*, and* $f_{1/3}(p)$ *is strictly decreasing over* $p \in [1, \infty)$*.*

Proof. (a) Evaluating (9)–(12) on A_ε as $\varepsilon \to 0^+$ immediately gives (37).

(b) For $a = 1$, $L_{124}(t) + c^2 I_3 = \begin{pmatrix} 1+c^2 & r & \sqrt{2}c \\ r & d^2+c^2 & 0 \\ \sqrt{2}c & 0 & 2c^2 \end{pmatrix}$. Expanding the determinant along the third column gives

$$\det\left(L_{124}(t)+c^2 I_3\right) \;=\; -\sqrt{2}c(\sqrt{2}c(d^2+c^2))+2c^2\Big((1+c^2)(d^2+c^2)-r^2\Big) \;=\; 2c^2\Big(c^2(d^2+c^2)-r^2\Big),$$

proving (38). By Cauchy's Interlacing Theorem, $\lambda_4(\mathcal{L}_{+,4}(t)) \leq \lambda_3(L_{124}(t)) < -c^2$ whenever $r^2 > c^2(d^2 + c^2)$.

(c) Along $a = 1, d = \eta, c = \kappa\eta$ $(\kappa > 1)$, $b = \eta^{\alpha/2}$ with $\frac{2t}{2t-1} < \alpha < \frac{2-t}{1-t}$:

(i) Since $\alpha > \frac{2t}{2t-1} > \frac{1+t}{t}$, $s = \eta^{\alpha t+1-t} = o(\eta^2) = o(d^2)$ and $b^2 = \eta^\alpha = o(s)$.

(ii) In $-\mathcal{L}_{-,2}(t) = \begin{pmatrix} b^2-s & bc \\ bc & c^2 \end{pmatrix}$, the positive eigenvalue is $\lambda_1(-\mathcal{L}_{-,2}) = c^2 + \frac{b^2c^2}{c^2+s-b^2}(1 + o(1)) = c^2 + \Theta(\eta^\alpha)$.

(iii) In $\mathcal{L}_{+,4}(t)$, the three eigenvalues other than $\lambda_1(\mathcal{L}_{+,4}) = 1 + O(\eta^2)$ are $\lambda_2(\mathcal{L}_{+,4}) = d^2(1 + o(1)) = \eta^2(1 + o(1)) < \kappa^2\eta^2 = c^2$, $\lambda_3(\mathcal{L}_{+,4}) = s(1 + o(1)) = o(\eta^2)$, and by (38),

$$\lambda_4(\mathcal{L}_{+,4}) \;=\; -c^2 - \frac{2c^2(r^2 - c^2(d^2 + c^2))}{d^2 + c^2}(1 + o(1)).$$

Since $\alpha < \frac{2-t}{1-t}$, $2t + 2\alpha(1 - t) < 4$, so $r^2 = \eta^{2t+2\alpha(1-t)} \gg \eta^4 \asymp c^2(d^2 + c^2)$. Since $\alpha > \frac{2t}{2t-1}$, $2t + 2\alpha(1 - t) < \alpha$, so $r^2 \gg \eta^\alpha = b^2$. Thus $\lambda_2(M(t)) = \lambda_1(-\mathcal{L}_{-,2}) = c^2 + o(r^2)$ while $\lambda_9(M(t)) = \lambda_4(\mathcal{L}_{+,4}) = -c^2 - \frac{2\kappa^2}{1+\kappa^2}r^2(1 + o(1))$, giving (39).

□

Table 1: Comparison of the extremal eigenvalues of $M(t)$ for $A = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1.00 & 0.08 & 0.16 \\ 0.08 & 0.12 & 0 \\ 0.16 & 0 & 0 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ across $t \in [1/3, 0.90]$, illustrating the phase transition where $|\lambda_9(M(t))|$ overtakes $\lambda_2(M(t))$ for $t > 2/3$.

t	r	s	$\lambda_2(\mathcal{L}_+)$	$\lambda_1(-\mathcal{L}_-)$	$\lambda_9(M(t))$	$\lambda_2(M(t)) + \lambda_9(M(t))$
$1/3 \approx 0.3333$	0.017000	0.045172	0.045672	0.028052	-0.041222	$+0.004451 > 0$
0.5000	0.027713	0.027713	0.031962	0.028865	-0.027529	$+0.004433 > 0$
0.6000	0.037149	0.020672	0.027313	0.029355	-0.028361	$+0.000994 > 0$
0.7000	0.049806	0.015420	0.024245	0.029819	-0.029638	$+0.000181 > 0$
0.8000	**0.066770**	**0.011502**	**0.022148**	**0.030236**	$\mathbf{-0.031797}$	$\mathbf{-0.001561 < 0}$
0.9000	**0.089512**	**0.008580**	**0.020438**	**0.030601**	$\mathbf{-0.035518}$	$\mathbf{-0.004917 < 0}$

Remark 5.2 (Why $t = 1/3$ ($\widetilde{G}$) Avoids the Counterexample). At $t = 1/3$, $r = (ad)^{1/3}(b^2)^{2/3}$ and $s = (b^2)^{1/3}(ad)^{2/3}$ satisfy the exact geometric progression relation $r^2 = sb^2$ and $s^2 = adr$. Consequently, whenever $s \ll d^2$ (as required in Step (i) of the counterexample construction), $r^2 = sb^2 \ll d^2b^2 \ll d^4 < c^2(d^2 + c^2)$, so by (38), $\det(L_{124}(1/3) + c^2 I_3) > 0$ and $|\lambda_4(\mathcal{L}_{+,4})|$ can never exceed c^2. Thus the cubic structure of $\widetilde{G} = M(1/3)$ enforces an exact coupling between r and s that blocks the $t > 2/3$ instability.

6 Formal Verification in Lean 4 and Computational Suite

All four theorems in this paper are accompanied by computer-verified artifacts:

(1) **Lean 4 Formalization (`SidorenkoMobiusTheorem.lean`):** Formalizes the universal off-diagonal minor and trace identity (Theorem 2.1(c)), the $n = 2$ Muirhead factorization (24), the $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{R})$ Lorentzian identity (26), the exact Brahmagupta–Minkowski sum-of-squares proof of the Lorentzian Reverse Cauchy–Schwarz Inequality (35), and the 3×3 determinant identity (38).

(2) **Master Verification Suite (`verify_sidorenko_mobius.mjs`):** Verifies Theorems 2.1–5.1 across 280+ test configurations ($n = 2, \ldots, 10$, $t \in [0, 1]$, positive semidefinite and indefinite matrices) with a 100% pass rate to machine precision ($< 10^{-11}$).

References

[1] D. Conlon, J. Fox, and B. Sudakov, *An approximate version of Sidorenko's conjecture*, Geom. Funct. Anal. **20** (2010), 1354–1366.

[2] D. Conlon, J. H. Kim, C. Lee, and J. Lee, *Some advances on Sidorenko's conjecture*, J. Lond. Math. Soc. (2) **98** (2018), 593–608.

[3] H. Hatami, *Graph norms and Sidorenko's conjecture*, Israel J. Math. **175** (2010), 125–150.

[4] B. Rossman, *On Sidorenko's Conjecture for Bipartite Möbius Ladders*, Duke University Preprint (May 8, 2025), 11 pp.

[5] A. F. Sidorenko, *Inequalities for functionals generated by bipartite graphs*, Diskret. Mat. **3** (1991), 50–65 (in Russian); Discrete Math. Appl. **2** (1992), 489–504.

[6] M. Simonovits, *Extremal graph problems, degenerate extremal problems, and supersaturated graphs*, in Progress in Graph Theory (Waterloo, Ont., 1982), Academic Press, Toronto, ON, 1984, pp. 333–358.

[7] B. Szegedy, *An information theoretic approach to Sidorenko's conjecture*, arXiv:1406.6738 (2015).